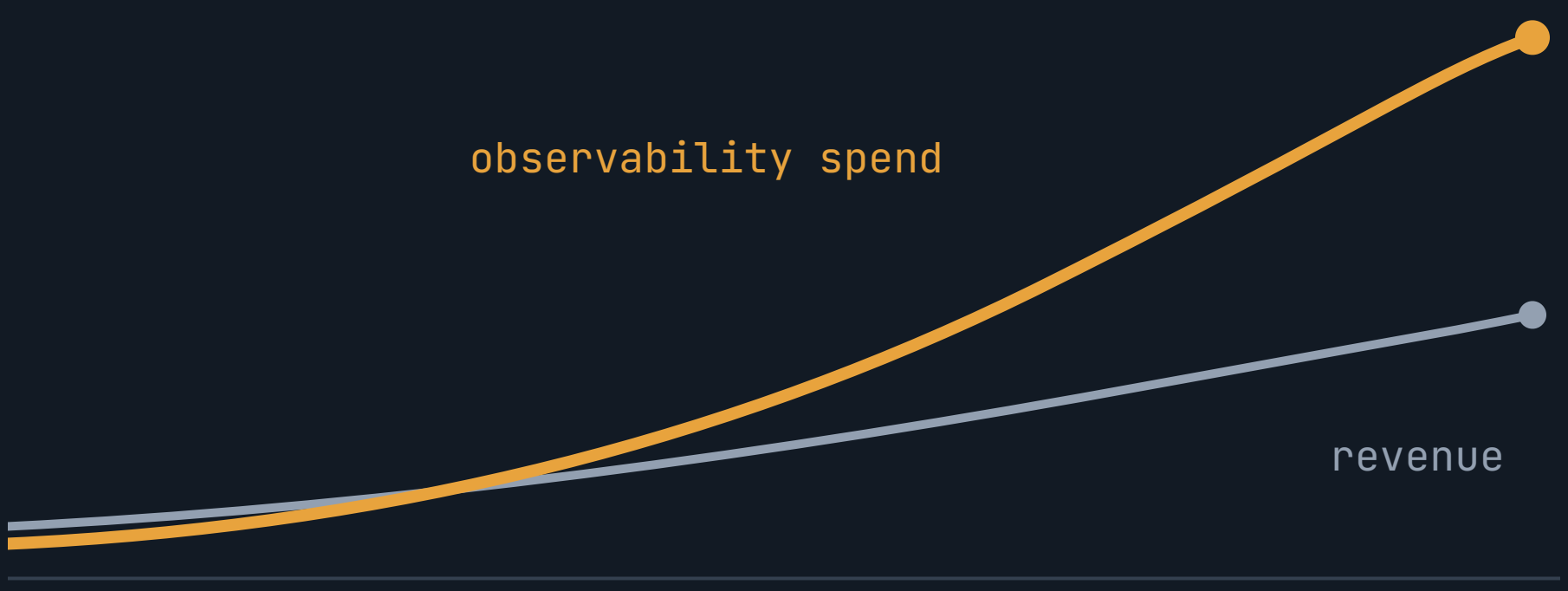
Your observability bill is growing faster than your revenue.

You never chose this. You inherited it, one agent and one dashboard at a time.



The old model breaks at scale.

- One proprietary agent per tool
- Every log ingested, at full price
- The same data stored in three platforms
- AI agents emit dozens of spans per request

More data. Less insight. Higher bill.

Own the signal.
Rent the screen.

BEFORE

Vendor

svc A svc B svc C svc D

Your data lives in their format.

AFTER

Your pipeline

Vendor 1 Vendor 2 Storage

Vendors are replaceable views.

Telemetry is a strategic data asset. Treat it like one.

Four layers.
Two you must own.

01	**Instrumentation** OpenTelemetry in every service	OWN
02	**Pipeline** Sample, redact, route	OWN
03	**Storage** Hot vs cold tiers	CHOOSE
04	**Analysis and UI** Dashboards, traces, evals	CHOOSE

Own layers 1 and 2, and **every vendor above them becomes swappable.**

Build, buy or hybrid?

Buy

Small platform team. Speed matters. Standard stack.

Build

Telemetry is your product, or sovereignty rules out every vendor.

Hybrid

MOST ENTERPRISES

You own the pipeline. Hot data goes to a vendor; the rest goes to cheap storage.

Pick by what you'll own.

SELF-HOST OR HYBRID

Langfuse
Phoenix
Opik
MLflow

Data stays with you

BUY, EVAL-FIRST

Braintrust
LangSmith
W&B Weave

Fastest path to CI-gated evals

COST GATEWAY

Helicone

Spend visibility in one line of setup

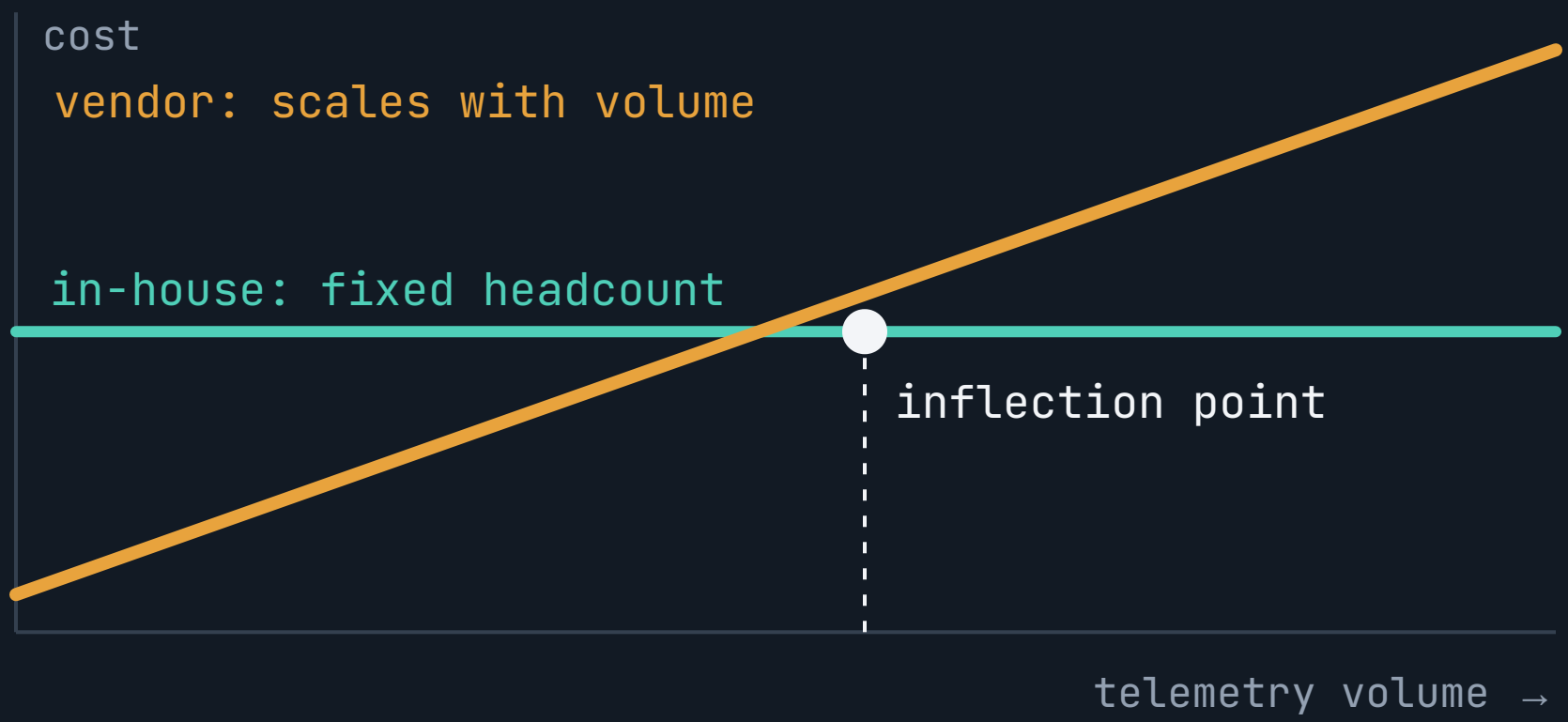
ALREADY ON APM

Datadog

LLM traces beside infra alerts

Full scored comparison, 7 criteria, sources: **link on the last slide.**

Price the engineers, not the licence.



- Cut ingest in your pipeline before you renegotiate.
- Build only when vendor spend reliably exceeds the team that would replace it.

Two traps that burn budgets.

Building your own UI

A year spent recreating what vendors ship every week.

Proprietary agents everywhere

Switching later means rewriting every service.

Build the plumbing, not the screens.

The framework in three lines.

1 Instrument once, with open standards.

2 Control volume and routing in your own pipeline.

3 Buy screens. Build only what differentiates. Revisit yearly.

The full analysis is open.

9 platforms, 7 criteria, every source. Set your own priorities and re-rank. Read the insights, the agent code and the skill. Comment on any page.

SCAN OR VISIT

agenticforze.github.io/agentic-observability-insights

What would you never outsource? Tell me in the comments.